

Worksheet: Freelance Economy Landscape

Name: ____ Date: ____

Instructions

This worksheet is for learning about the landscape of freelance/service work — it is **not** an instruction to sign up for anything. Fill in the table using what was taught in class, and answer the reflection questions honestly based on your own situation right now. Rules on these platforms change, so the "verified as of" column matters — it records when the rule was last checked, not that it's permanent.

Important: Never misrepresent your age on any platform to get around an age rule. If a rule doesn't currently allow your situation, that's real information to plan around — not a problem to work around by lying.

Part 1: Platform / Model Comparison

Platform or model	What it's generally used for	Age & account rules (as generally understood — verify before relying on it)	Verified as of (date checked)
Fiverr	Clients post requests or freelancers list fixed-price "gigs" for services like design, writing, video editing, voice work, and more.	Users aged 13–17 may use Fiverr only through an account owned/managed by a parent or legal guardian. Fiverr's terms describe the age floor and the parental-account requirement; check Fiverr's current Terms of Service for exact wording.	—
Upwork	Larger and longer freelance projects and contracts, often for professional/business clients, across writing, development, design, admin work, and more.	Upwork generally requires users to be 18 or the age of majority in their location; it is not structured for a minor's account, even with a parent's involvement.	—
Etsy	An online marketplace mainly for selling handmade goods, art, craft supplies, and some digital/print-on-demand products.	Etsy allows users aged 13–17 to have a shop only through a parent or legal guardian's account, with that adult responsible for the shop. Check Etsy's current seller policies for exact terms.	—
Gumroad	A platform for selling digital products directly — templates, ebooks, music,	Age and account requirements vary by country and can change; Gumroad's own terms and payment-processor requirements	—

Platform or model	What it's generally used for	Age & account rules (as generally understood — verify before relying on it)	Verified as of (date checked)
	courses, design assets — without a traditional storefront.	should be checked directly rather than assumed.	
Direct referrals (family friends, neighbors, school/community contacts)	Someone you or your family already knows asks you directly to do a specific job (like Mara's logo example) — no platform involved.	No platform account or age gate applies, but a parent/guardian should still be aware of the arrangement, the price, and how payment is handled, especially for anyone under 18.	—

Reminder: platform rules can and do change. Before relying on any rule in this table for a real decision, check the platform's current official Terms of Service or Help Center page yourself (with a parent/guardian, if you're a minor).

Part 2: Reflection Questions

1. Which of the five rows in the table above best fits your situation right now (your age, and whether a parent/guardian could be involved in an account or a specific job)? Why?

2. Is there a skill you already have that could realistically become a service through the "direct referrals" model (someone you or your family knows) before you'd ever need a platform account at all? Describe it.

3. If you wanted to use one of the marketplace platforms (Fiverr, Upwork, Etsy, or Gumroad) in the future, what would you need to have in place first (for example: a parent/guardian's involvement, reaching a certain age, having a portfolio of work to show)? Be specific to the platform you chose.